



Above A classic bouillabaisse in the Marseille style, with the broth and the fish, garnished with lemon and herbs, served separately

Left Seagulls wheel hopefully above a fisherman selling his catch on the Quai des Belges, Marseille's exuberant fish market



Above Boats moored in the Vieux Port, with the basilica of Notre Dame de la Garde reaching into the sky in the background

What Else to Eat

Pizza is big in Marseille, and even the pizza vans that dot the city dish up a mean crust. Best of all are the thin-crust, wood-fired pizzas from Le Panier restaurant **Chez Etienne** (43 rue de Lorette, no telephone). For North African delights, find delicious couscous, tagines, and pastries from boisterous Algerian canteen **Sur le Pouce** (+33 4 9156 1328), near the Marché des Capucins. The weird and wonderful chocolates made by the Le Ray family at their shop, **La Chocolatière du Panier** (+33 4 9155 7041), are also unmissable: try black cherry, ginger, lavender, basil, lime, and coriander, and even onion paired with chocolate.

The Best Places to Eat Bouillabaisse

Le Petit Nice expensive

Gérald Passédât's three-star Michelin eatery sits on an idyllic rocky point surveying the blue, blue Mediterranean. The chef is so attached to his surroundings and Marseille's culinary heritage that he's devoted an entire tasting menu to bouillabaisse. It's an extravagantly poetic, and expensive, version of the original, inspired by Passédât's childhood memories – he was born on this very spot. His dedication to achieving the most intense, authentic flavors begins with the fish stock, boiling down live rock crabs and an assembly of small rockfish (it takes some 6 lb of fresh fish to make a quart of stock) to fashion the fragrant base of the dish. The bouillabaisse menu is then served in three courses, kicking off with a mussel and clam carpaccio with fried strips of *girelle* (rainbow wrasse), followed by the catch of the day, perfectly cooked in a sea-spiked artichoke broth. Then comes the soup: red scorpion fish, sea bream, and potatoes in a saffron-rich broth, with *rouille*, of course.

Anse de Maldormé, Corniche JF Kennedy; open for lunch and dinner Tue–Sat (open Mon evening in July and August); www.petitnice-passedat.com

Also in Marseille

The lovely setting of **L'Epuisette** (www.l-epuisette.com; expensive) alone makes it worth a visit. Luckily, the bouillabaisse cooked up by Guillaume Sourrieu is just as impressive. Perched on the jetty in the tiny cove of Vallon des Auffes, this is an impossibly perfect spot for a plate of deluxe fish soup and a platter of squeaky fresh monkfish, red scorpion fish, John Dory, conger eel (all Bouillabaisse Charter-sanctioned), and waxy yellow potatoes, infused with the perkier saffron broth around.

Also in France

Fittingly, it's a former fisherman's hut that's home to Saint-Tropez's top seafood soup. **Chez Camille** (www.chezcamille.fr; moderate), perched at one end of the bay of Pampelonne, has been dishing up simple seafood since it was mistaken for a beach bistro back in the '50s by director Roger Vadim and his then-wife, Brigitte Bardot. Locals claim it serves up one of the best bouillabaisse on the Riviera.

Around the World

Whatever the weather in London, you can get a taste of sunshine at **Bistro Bruno Loubet** at the Zetter Hotel (www.bistrobrunoloubet.com; moderate). Ex-Michelin-star chef Bruno Loubet cooks up affordable French food, from rustic favorites like the bouillabaisse with *rouille* and croutons to classics with a modern bent, such as duck *confit* with honey and North African spice.